



RESEARCH AND
ENGINEERING

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

OFFICE OF THE UNDER SECRETARY OF DEFENSE

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20301

FEDERAL GOVERNMENT

9 FEB 1981

B77

MEMORANDUM FOR THE DIRECTOR, FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION

SUBJECT: Papers Recovered on the Death of Nicola Tesla (U)

(U) We understand that the FBI may have possession of a number of papers found after the death of Nicola Tesla in 1943. Nicola Tesla was a brilliant electrical engineer (i.e. the Tesla Coil) who was a pioneer in various aspects of electrical transmission phenomena.

(C) We believe that certain of Tesla's papers may contain basic principles which would be of considerable value to certain ongoing research within the DoD. It would be very helpful to have access to his papers.

(U) Since we have really no idea of the possible volume of these papers, we would be happy to provide a researcher who could assist you in reducing the magnitude of the search. If there are further questions, I am the point of contact within the DoD and can be reached at 695-6364 or 695-7417.

Allan J. MacLaren

Allan J. MacLaren
LtColonel, USAF
Military Assistant
Strategic and Space Systems

REGISTERED

1059638

FBI
ALL INFORMATION CONTAINED
HEREIN IS UNCLASSIFIED

DATE 4-8-93 BY 9803

FOIPA No. 356,608
362,001

b7C

100-2237-33

Per DoD letter dated 3-29-93
with Enclosures 1 and 2
ALL DoD info is unclassified
DoD referenced FOIA # 356,608 and 362,001

4/8/93 9803

362,001

ALL INFORMATION CONTAINED

HEREIN IS UNCLASSIFIED

DATE 11-14-89 BY 5801/001/002

b7C

Classified by: DUSORE/S&SS
Declassify on: February 1987

DECLASSIFIED BY 1048

ON 1-27-93

Per Army letter 5-15-89

291760

CORRESPONDENCE

50 MAR 30 1981

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FBI

TRANSMIT VIA:

☐ Teletype
☐ Facsimile
☒ AIRTEL

PRECEDENCE:

☐ Immediate
☐ Priority
☐ Routine

CLASSIFICATION:

☐ TOP SECRET
☐ SECRET
☐ CONFIDENTIAL
☐ UNCLAS E F T O
☐ UNCLAS

Date 8/18/83

SECRET

TO: DIRECTOR, FBI
 ATTN: INTD, SUPERVISOR [REDACTED]

FROM: SAC, CINCINNATI [REDACTED] (P)

NIKOLA TESLA

(OO: CI)

This communication is classified "Secret" in its entirety.

Re telephone call of SA [REDACTED], Cincinnati Division, to Supervisor [REDACTED] FBIHQ, on 8/11/83.

Enclosed for the Bureau and New York is one copy each of pertinent pages from the 1981 book titled "Tesla: Man Out of Time" by Margaret Cheney, with important passages underlined.

For information of Bureau and New York, [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] WRIGHT-Patterson Air Force Base (WPAB) and [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] also at WPAB, have both been in contact with SA [REDACTED] at the Dayton, Ohio RA regarding possible FBI [REDACTED]

SECRET

Classified by: 8262
 Declassify on: OADR

Classified by: [REDACTED]

Declassify on: OADR

- 2 - Bureau (Enc. 1)
 2 - New York (Enc. 1)
 2 - Cincinnati

(6)

ALL INFORMATION CONTAINED
 HEREIN IS UNCLASSIFIED
 EXCEPT WHERE SHOWN
 OTHERWISE

17 AUG 22 1993

Approved: [REDACTED]

Transmitted

(Number) (Time)

53 NOV 1983

involvement in the seizing of Nikola Tesla's research papers and other documents and scientific instruments after his death on January 7, 1943.

1886
They both explained that Tesla was a scientific genius and experimenter, who was born in Yugoslavia of Serbian parents on 7/10/56, went to school later in Gratz, Austria, Prague, Czechoslovakia and Paris, France. He immigrated to the U.S. in the early 1880's, worked for Thomas Edison's laboratory for a couple of years, then started his own lab after being paid \$1 million dollars for rights to his patents on his polyphase systems of alternating current dynamos, which lead to the harnessing of Niagra Falls for producing electricity and then the power system of the whole country. He was naturalized in 1889. He predicted wireless communication (radio). His later experiments in Colorado and elsewhere led to his producing artificial lightning in the millions of volts. He also had patents on the concept of neon and fluorescent lights, but he later made little money on his later inventions, although he continued to do experiments leading to devices of great potential worth, which he never patented. He became more reclusive in his later years, living in various hotels in New York City. In the 1930's he claimed he had developed the concept and method of building a "death ray", which could destroy planes at many miles distant, for defending America. Also, there are reports of resonance machines or devices whereby he could shake one or many large city buildings from some distance away.

Both [REDACTED] and [REDACTED] said that Tesla donated "some" of his papers (or copies thereof) to the Tesla Institute in Belgrade, Yugoslavia; set up in the 1930's in his honor by their government. Biographies on Tesla claim that either the custodian of Alien Property and/or the FBI seized his papers and other personal effects, including a safe or safes, and other property immediately after his death in 1943. This is elaborated on in the enclosed copies of certain pages of Margaret Cheney's book, "Tesla: Man Out of Time".

[REDACTED] said that after World War II Tesla's papers were shipped to the Tesla Institute in Belgrade, Yugoslavia, by his nephew, Sava Kosanovic, who had become Tito's Ambassador to the U.S. There were reports that some microfilming of Tesla's papers by government agents while they were still in storage in New York under Kosanovic's custody.